

Estimated Breakdown (Session 12 example: 8-hour full cycle)

Pure analytical work:

- Search execution (with logging): ~1.5–2 hours
- Reading/reasoning through 25 docs: ~1.5–2 hours
- Pattern finding, participant mapping: ~1 hour
- **Subtotal: 4–5 hours of actual analysis**

Governance/logging/verification overhead:

- CIPDA framing & scope definition: ~30–45 min
- Reconciliation (27 vs. 34 candidate sets diverged): ~30–45 min
- Hash/verification operations on files: ~15–30 min
- Ledger entries & documentation: ~30–45 min
- Operator checkpoints & approvals: ~1–1.5 hours
- ROMER report writing (making path visible): ~1–1.5 hours
- **Subtotal: 4.5–5 hours overhead**

Net: 60–65% overhead for governance discipline

Context That Matters:

The article hints at the alternative: "A careful manual review might have taken tens of hours."

Session 9 example (the smoke test):

- Direct search: 5–15 minutes
- Instrumented rerun via MCP with logging: ~26 minutes + reconciliation
- That's ~2x overhead, but you get a defensible record

If Session 12 had been manual:

- Paralegal reading 81 messages, deduping, building chronology, mapping participants: 40–60 hours (easily)
- Or uncertain quality from junior work: 20–30 hours with gaps

So even with 65% governance overhead:

- 8 hours (supervised AI) vs. 40–60 hours (manual) = **80–90% time savings**
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The Real Cost:

The overhead isn't wasted—it's the price of defensibility. Each checkpoint, hash, ledger entry, and ROMER record is insurance that you can explain the work later. Without it, you'd save maybe 2–3 hours on an 8-hour job but lose the ability to defend the findings.

For the SCL paper, this should probably be quantified as:

- "Governance and verification added approximately 60–65% to per-session processing time"
- "Against manual review baselines (40–60 hours for comparable work), AI-assisted analysis with full logging remained 5–8× faster"
- "The overhead is the cost of producing defensible evidence, not wasted effort"

Does that frame make sense for the article, or would you want different numbers?